ENG-0014 Incident Postmortem: INC-041

Impact

The incident designated as INC-041 affected the ledger-worker system (SYS-014), which is integral to Project Fathom. The system's medium criticality status means that its downtime could have impacted financial processing and data integrity within the project scope. The incident resulted in a service disruption lasting approximately 19.5 hours, during which users experienced degraded functionality or unavailability of ledger-related features. Although the incident was contained and resolved, the extended resolution time underscores the importance of addressing hardware reliability to prevent future occurrences.

Timeline

- **2025-03-26**: The incident was reported by Mark Perez, a Paralegal, indicating issues with the ledger-worker system. Alyssa Long, the on-call Product Manager, was alerted to the problem.
- **Incident Detection**: The hardware failure was identified as the root cause of the system outage.
- **Resolution Duration**: The technical team worked to resolve the hardware failure, which took approximately 19.5 hours.
- **2025-03-26**: The ledger-worker system was fully restored and operational. The incident was documented and closed.

Root Cause

The root cause of INC-041 was categorized as a hardware failure within the ledger-worker system (SYS-014). This hardware failure led to system downtime and service disruption. The hardware component failure was not specified beyond its classification, but it was significant enough to impair system functionality for nearly a full day.

Action Items

Action Item	Responsible Party	Due Date	Notes
Conduct a comprehensive hardware audit of ledger-worker components	Engineering Team	2025-04-05	To identify potential vulnerabilities and prevent recurrence.
Implement proactive hardware monitoring and alerting	Infrastructure Team	2025-04-12	To enable early detection of hardware issues.
Review and update hardware maintenance schedules	Operations Department	2025-04-10	Ensure timely maintenance and replacement of aging hardware.

Action Item	Responsible Party	Due Date	Notes
Document hardware failure incident and update incident response procedures	Incident Response Team	2025-04-15	To improve response efficiency for future hardware failures.
Schedule training for on-call engineers, including Alyssa Long, on hardware troubleshooting	HR and Training	2025-04-20	To enhance team readiness for hardware-related incidents.

Additional Notes

The incident was reported by Mark Perez and managed by Alyssa Long, who is the designated on-call employee for the ledger-worker system. The resolution took approximately 19.5 hours, emphasizing the need for improved hardware resilience and monitoring. As Project Fathom continues to evolve, ongoing attention to hardware reliability will be critical to maintaining system availability and integrity.